PROPOSAL · 9 JUNE 2026

Fund a Customer Success team

Three hires to stop the churn that's quietly costing us $1.2M a year.

The ask: fund three Customer Success roles, starting this quarter.

We are proposing three Customer Success hires at roughly $400K fully loaded. The case is simple: churn among our largest accounts is costing far more than the team would. This proposal makes the ask, justifies it, and asks again — so you can decide today.

The problem: our biggest accounts leave because no one owns them.

Accounts over $50K have no dedicated owner after the sale. They onboard themselves, hit friction, and churn at renewal — and we only find out when the renewal doesn't come. Sales can't catch it; support is reactive. Nobody's job is keeping these accounts successful.

- Eight of our top forty accounts churned or downgraded last year.
- Exit interviews cite "we never heard from anyone" as the top reason.

THE COST OF DOING NOTHING

$1.2M

in annual recurring revenue lost last year to large-account churn we could have seen coming.

What a Customer Success team would own.

01

A named owner per account

Every account over $50K gets one person accountable for its health.

02

Proactive check-ins

Quarterly business reviews catch friction before it reaches renewal.

03

A health score

Usage, support volume, and sentiment roll into one early-warning signal.

04

Renewal ownership

CS owns the renewal conversation, starting ninety days out.

Why three, and why now.

Three CS managers can each own about twenty-five large accounts — enough to cover our top seventy-five, which is where the churn concentrates. Waiting a quarter means another renewal cycle runs through the same gap that cost us $1.2M.

- The next major renewal window opens in October — three at-risk accounts in it.
- Three is the minimum that covers the at-risk segment without overloading.

PROPOSAL · YEAR-ONE TARGETS

What $400K in CS would return in the first year.

−60%

Large-account churn

FROM $1.2M TO UNDER $500K ✓ON PLAN FINANCE

75

Accounts covered

THE ENTIRE AT-RISK SEGMENT

✓ON PLAN CS

3.5×

Return on cost

$1.4M RETAINED ON $400K SPEND

✓ON PLAN FINANCE

BENCHMARK · COMPANIES OUR SIZE

What peer companies see after staffing Customer Success.

From an industry survey of 60 SaaS companies at $10–30M ARR.

−55%
LARGE-ACCOUNT CHURN

+18%
NET REVENUE RETENTION

4 mo
PAYBACK ON CS COST

+12
NET PROMOTER SCORE

How we'd stand the team up in ninety days.

STEP 01

Hire the lead

Recruit an experienced CS lead first; they shape the playbook and hire the other two.

STEP 02

Segment the accounts

Rank the top seventy-five by churn risk so coverage starts where it matters.

STEP 03

Launch QBRs

Begin quarterly business reviews with the highest-risk accounts immediately.

STEP 04

Stand up the health score

Wire usage and support data into one dashboard by the end of the quarter.

The ask again: approve three CS hires this quarter.

FUND THE THREE CS ROLES

$400K to protect $1.2M and stop finding out about churn at renewal.

HOLD FOR ANOTHER QUARTER

Defers the cost, but runs the October renewals through the same blind spot.

CUSTOMER SUCCESS PROPOSAL · SUCCESS@EXAMPLE.COM

Three hires to protect $1.2M — let's fund them now.